Acolyte *Incense, Parchment & Ink (3u), Random Spellbook* **Acrobat** *Pole, Rope, Smokebomb* **Alchemist** *Acid, Lens, Oilskin Bag* **Apothecary** *Antitoxin, Bandages (3u), Sealable Bottle* **Assassin** *Garrotte, Mask, Poison* **Astrologer** *Candle (3u, dim), Marbles, Spyglass* **Baker** *Flour, Honey, Sealable Bottle* **Barber-Surgeon** *Bandages (3u), Scissors, Sedative* **Barkeep** *Alcohol, Sealable Bottle, Sedative* 10 **Beadle** *Bell, Gloves (p), Whistle (p)* **Beekeeper** *Fire Oil, Gloves (p), Honey* **Bell Ringer** *Gloves (p), Rope, Whistle (p)* **Bird Keeper** *Cage, Net, Whistle (p)* **Blacksmith** *Bellows, Hammer, Iron Tongs* **Bookbinder** *Glue, Parchment & Ink (3u), Sewing Kit* **Bounty Hunter** *Flash Powder, Manacles, Rope* **Butcher** *Pail, Saw, Whetstone* **Carpenter** *Hammer, Metal File, Saw* **Cartographer** *Compass, Parchment & Ink (3u), Sextant* 20 **Cartwright** *Hand Drill, Pulley, Saw* **Chandler** *Candle (3u, dim), Honey, Perfume* **Charlatan** *Cards, Paint, Perfume* **Chimney Sweep** *Bellows, Climbing Spikes, Rope* **Clockmaker** *Magnifying Glass, Metal File, Pliers* **Cobbler** *Pliers, Sack, Sewing Kit* **Cook** *Flour, Pail, Smoking Herbs (3u)* **Cooper** *Hammer, Hand Drill, Saw* **Courier** *Bell, Compass, Parchment & Ink (3u)* **Crypt Custodian** *Incense, Lantern, Oil Can (6u)* 30 **Cultist** *Incense, Mask, Scroll of Random Spellbook (p)* **Demolitionist** *Explosive, Goggles, Grease* **Dowser** *Dowsing Rod, Sealable Bottle, Shovel* **Duelist** *Cloak (p), Gloves (p), Whetstone* **Entertainer** *Dice, Songbook, Wig* **Executioner** *Mask, Rope, Whetstone* **Falconer** *Cage, Gloves (p), Whistle (p)* **Farmer** *Rope, Sack, Shovel* **Fence** *Bolt Cutters, Random Additional Gear, Sack* **Fisher** *Air Bladder, Fishing Rod, Net* 40 **Fletcher** *Sack, Trap, Whetstone* **Gambler** *Alcohol, Cards, Dice* **Gardener** *Gloves (p), Sack, Shovel* **Glassblower** *Goggles, Lens, Pliers* **Gong Farmer** *Gloves (p), Sack, Shovel* **Gravedigger** *Alcohol, Ladder, Shovel* **Guard** *Lantern, Manacles, Whistle (p)* **Herald** *Mask, Signal Flag, Whistle (p)* **Herbalist** *Antitoxin, Mugwort, Sack* **Hermit** *Blanket, Pole, Smoking Herbs (3u)* 50 **Highway Robber** *Grappling Hook, Rope, Signal Flag* **Hunter** *Trap, Rope, Smoking Herbs (3u)* **Illusionist** *Candle (3u, dim), Flash Powder, Mirror* **Innkeeper** *Alcohol, Bandages (3u), Parchment & Ink (3u)* **Jailer** *Chain, Manacles, Whistle (p)* **Jester** *Cards, Lute, Perfume* **Jeweler** *Magnifying Glass, Pliers, Tongs* **Knight** *Gloves (p), Signal Flag, Whetstone* **Lamplighter** *Ladder (10ft, b), Oil Can (6u), Whistle (p)* **Leech Collector** *Gloves (p), Leech (restores 1 STR, 3u), Net* 60 **Librarian** *Candle (3u, dim), Parchment & Ink (3u), random Scroll (p)* **Locksmith** *Lock & Key, Metal File, Pliers* **Lumberjack** *Rope, Saw, Whetstone* **Mason** *Chisel, Fan, Hammer* **Merchant** *Random Additional Gear, Stylus, Wagon (+8s, slow)* **Miller** *Bowl, Flour, Rope* **Miner** *Lantern, Lodestone, Pickaxe* **Monk** *Candle (3u, dim), Cloak (p), Songbook* **Musician** *Bowl, Fiddle, Songbook* **Naturalist** *Hammock, Rope, Spyglass* 70 **Navigator** *Compass, Poncho (p), Spyglass* **Oil Collector** *Lantern, Oil Can (6u), Sealable Bottle* **Painter** *Paint, Parchment & Ink (3u), Stylus* **Peddler** *Cart (+4s, b), Random Additional Gear, Sack* **Philosopher** *Chalk (p), Parchment & Ink, Pipe* **Physician** *Antitoxin, Bandages (3u), Crowbar* **Pilgrim** *Blanket, Pole, Poncho (p)* **Potter** *Chisel, Pail, Tongs* **Priest** *Bandages (3u), Candle (3u, dim), Incense* **Prospector** *Lantern, Lodestone, Pickaxe* 80 **Rat Catcher** *Sack, Trap, Whistle (p)* **Sailor** *Hammock, Rope, Spyglass* **Scribe** *Candle (3u, dim), Parchment & Ink (3u), Stylus* **Shepherd** *Cloak (p), Rope, Whistle (p)* **Smuggler** *Lock & Key, Oilskin Bag, Rope* **Soldier** *Spiked Boots, Tent (fits 2, b), Whetstone* **Spy** *Disguise Kit, Garrotte, Mirror* **Stablehand** *Blanket, Rope, Shovel* **Street Preacher** *Bell, Parchment & Ink, Scroll of Random Spellbook (p)* **Tailor** *Cloak (p), Scissors, Sewing Kit* 90 **Tanner** *Gloves (p), Pliers, Tar* **Tax Collector** *Parchment & Ink (3u), Sealable Bottle, Whistle (p)* **Thief** *Caltrops, Grappling Hook, Lockpick* **Tinker** *Grease, Hammer, Pliers* **Toll Keeper** *Bell, Lock & Key, Waterproof Bag* **Toymaker** *Glue, Pliers, Scissors* **Vagabond** *Blanket, Poncho (p), Rope* **Vintner** *Alcohol, Rope, Sealable Bottle* **Weaver** *Perfume, Rope, Scissors* **Witch** *Candle (3u, dim), Spellbook, Wolfsbane* **Witchfinder** *Rope, Scroll of Random Spellbook (p), Spyglass*

Cairn

Cheat Sheet

a rules summary for the game by Yochai Gal
fit for rules-light fantasy tabletop roleplaying

General Principles: **Neutrality** *The Warden is a neutral arbiter to portray the world clearly* **Classless** *Specialities are defined by the characters' equipment and experiences* **Death** *It's always a threat, but never random or without warning* **Fiction First** *Success and failure derive from the context rather than dice* **Growth** *Characters change through in-world advancement and overcoming obstacles* **Player Choice** *Players should understand the reasons behind choices with potential risks provided freely* **Principles** *Warden and Players follow guidelines to foster critical thinking, exploration and emergent narrative* **Shared Objectives** *Players engage with the shared setting, goals and challenges together*

For The Players: **Agency** *Rely on intuition, items and connections more than attributes* **Teamwork** *Seek consensus and accomplish more together* **Exploration** *Ask about details to find more than one way forward* **Talking** *Treat NPCs like real people mostly acting in self-interest* **Caution** *Stack odds in your favor and retreat when it's unfavorable* **Planning** *Avoid obstacles through reconnaissance and research* **Ambition** *Earn reputation through own goals that keep things moving*

For The Warden: **Information** *Provide useful information freely and let the players keep asking* **Difficulty** *Default to context and realism to only roll for uncertain outcomes* **Preparation** *Develop situations organically through actions affecting the world* **Narrative Focus** *Induce emergent play along the needs of players, but with consequences* **Danger** *Telegraph dangerous threats more obvious with opportunities to solve the problem* **Treasure** *Lure players to a valuable item that tells a story but often entails trouble* **Choice** *Give players solid choices that move the situations forward*

Character

◆ Attributes

Attributes are not universal descriptors, they just determine the risk of actions.

Strength (STR) 3d6
physical power, like lifting gates, bending bars, resisting poison, etc.

Dexterity (DEX) 3d6
poise, speed, reflexes, dodging, climbing, sneaking, balancing, etc.

Willpower (WIL) 3d6
persuade, deceive, interrogate, intimidate, charm, provoke, manipulate spells, etc.

Hit Protection (HP) 1d6
character's ability to avoid damage in combat, depleted like stamina

- save with 1d20 ≤ attribute
- 1 always succeeds, 20 always fails
- whoever most at risk should save
- 1d6 for uncertain events

◆ Inventory

All items on a character are part of their inventory providing them capabilities.

Inventory slots are 10 (4-5 w/o backpack)
expanded with carts, wagons, pack animals, hirelings, etc.

Items occupy 0, 1, 2 slots
a petty cloak, regular gambeson and bulky chainmail for example

Fatigue (f) occupies 1 slot
obtained when deprived, casting spells and from events in fiction

Spellbooks occupy 1 slot
contain one spell to be cast, are unique and attract attention

Scrolls occupy 0 slots
contain one spell to be cast once and disappear afterwards

Relics are special items
imbued with a magical spell or power, of limited use and with a recharge condition

Armor (ARM) 0-3 max
from items worn or held

- full inventory reduces HP to 0
- multiple uses (u) for certain items

Starting equipment includes
- 3d6 coins, rations (3u) and a torch (3u)
- 3 items or less from background
- 1 weapon and 1 armor
- 1 additional gear

◆ Background

Abilities and privileges often derive from who the character is in the world.

Traits for character's appearance
Age, Physique, Skin, Hair, Face, Speech, Clothing, Virtue and Vice

Past that led here
- what experiences formed the character
- should offer an item and/or ability

Present circumstances
- what broadly defines the PC today
- related to specific item or skill

Bond ties PC to the world
- item/ability encouraging engagement
- initiates quest, opportunity or plan

Omen seeds a looming adventure
- world peculiarities yet unknown
- slowly reveals something going on
- rolled once by youngest PC

Downtime

Activities between game sessions
- one downtime action per PC at a time
- while safe and not recovering

Milestones track progress
- 1-5 complete, non-interactive tasks
- distinct for different strategies
- may change due to events in game

Costs often required for milestones
e.g. coins, resources, reputation, loss
- if unable to pay, find another way
- reduced by skill, connections and will
- with risks for failure

◆ Actions

Research investigation requires
- clearly formulated question
- source of knowledge in game world
- may spend action to find source

Training certain skills requires
- precise description what to improve
- master whom to train with
- inspired by experience in play
- clear narrative or mechanical result

Strengthen Ties in game world requires
- identified person or faction for ties
- specific intent (trust, membership, etc.)
- concrete measures to advance ties

Growth

- tied to in-game experience affecting PC
- logical result of actions and events
- fosters further interaction with world
- makes character more interesting/fun
- may happen by cumulative experiences

◆ Triggers

PCs engaging in two of the following:
- acts consistent around single objective
- takes obvious risks of unknown effects
- interacts with unique item/being/entity

Interacting with opaque thing or being
e.g. taking and ingesting heartseed

Long-term interaction with spell or relic
e.g. often using and manipulating spell

Forging relationship with great power
e.g. free deity trapped in a statue

Overcoming long-time woe, misdeed, foe
e.g. trap spirit of defeated serial murderer

Injury or contamination
e.g. eat decomposed after fungal infection

Learning through trial and error
e.g. throw net in combat repeatedly

Success/failure despite natural talent
e.g. sneaking successfully despite low dexterity

Faction advancement
e.g. complete initiation to an order

Resolution of bond or omen
e.g. cure stone heart as instructed

Wilderness

Watches (w) divide day into 3 segments
morning, afternoon and night

Day is 2w actions and 1w rest
used as shorthand for travel time

◆ Procedure

A round of exploration includes:

1. (Warden rolls for weather each day)
2. Warden describes location and paths
3. Players plot or adjust course
4. Players choose 1 action each
5. Warden narrates results
6. Warden rolls event (twice at night)
7. Players respond to results
8. All record any new conditions

◆ Events

[1] **Encounter** *rolled on a table specific to terrain or location, including NPC reaction*

[2] **Sign** *revealing a clue, spoor or indication of a nearby encounter, locality, feature, etc.*

[3] **Environment** *shift in weather or terrain*

[4] **Loss** *of resource, time, effort by tough choice*

[5] **Exhaustion** *encountering a barrier, forcing to spend time or add fatigue*

[6] **Discovery** *of food, treasure, other useful resources or a primary feature instead*

◆ Duration

Travel time between locations is determined by multiple factors adding up.

Distance between locations
- short (1w), medium (2w), long (3w)

Terrain (T) along the way
- easy (0w), tough (1w), perilous (2w)

Path connecting locations
- road (0w), trail (1w), wilderness (2w)

Weather during travel
- nice (0w), fair (0w), unpleasant (1w / 1f), inclement (1w / 1f + T↑), extreme (1w + 1f + T↑), catastrophic (no travel)
- extreme rolled twice makes catastrophic
- nighttime (1w) could negate hot weather
- roll 1d6 for current season:
  - `n f f u i e` (spring)
  - `n n f u i e` (summer)
  - `f f u i i e` (fall)
  - `f u i i e e` (winter)

Reduced by good preparation
- mounts, guides, maps, etc.
- spending resources or fatigue

◆ Actions

Travel to another location together
- reveals obvious locations and features
- get lost on trails (2/6) or wilderness (3/6)
- odds from path, maps, skills, guides
- recover way or end at near location
- T↑ traveling sleep-deprived

Explore current location
- search hidden features, scout ahead
- discovers location or feature

Supply with resources
- hunt, fish or forage for food
- 1/2/x people find 1d4/1d6/x rations
- experience/equipment increase bounty
- encountered houses resupply for coins

Camp set up in safe place
- PCs and mounts consume rations
- sleep unmolested with lookout rotation
- all able to rest lose all fatigue
- skipped camp makes deprived + 1f

Dungeons

◆ Procedure

A round of dungeon exploration includes:

1. Warden describes room and dangers
2. Players state PCs intended actions
   1. Move up to 40ft (12m)
   2. Move again twice or do other action
3. Warden resolves actions together
4. Players record any new conditions
5. Warden rolls event if appropriate

Dungeon events are rolled when the party
- spends more than 1 round in a place
- moves into a new area, level or zone
- moves quickly/aimlessly through a room
- creates a loud disturbance

◆ Events

[1] **Encounter** *rolled on a suitable table, including NPC reaction*

[2] **Sign** *revealing a clue, spoor, lair, victim, etc.*

[3] **Environment** *surroundings shift or escalate, either location or NPCs*

[4] **Loss** *of a resource (torch light, active spell, etc.) to be resolved before moving on*

[5] **Exhaustion** *requiring a brief rest that adds fatigue or consumes rations*

[6] **Quiet**, *all alone and safe for the time being*

◆ Elements

Actions require effort
- time, skill, items, health, people, etc.

Resting requires light and safety
- restores HP but not fatigue

Panicked in darkness, fear or surrounded
- 0 HP, impaired, lose first combat round
- make WIL save to overcome condition

Light sources illuminate 40ft (12m)
- last until put out by character or event
- can be lit 3 times, some refill with oil

Reactions of NPCs rolled with 2d6
- hostile [2], wary [3-5], curious [6-8], kind [9-11], helpful [12]

Hirelings can accompany PCs
- with skill, knowledge and training
- created like a character

Gear (d100)

Acid, Air Bladder, Alcohol, Antitoxin, Bandages (3u), Bell, Bellows, Blanket, Boltcutters **10** *Bowl, Cage, Caltrops, Candle (3u, dim), Cards, Cart (+4 slots, bulky), Chain (10ft), Chalk (petty), Chisel, Climbing Spikes* **20** *Cloak (petty), Compass, Crowbar, Dice, Dowsing Rod, Explosive, Fan, Fiddle, Fire Oil, Fishing Rod* **30** *Flash Powder, Flour, Garrotte, Gloves (petty), Glue, Goggles, Grappling Hook, Grease, Hammer, Hammock* **40** *Hand Drill, Honey, Hourglass, Incense, Ladder (10 ft, bulky), Lantern, Leech (restores 1 STR, 3u), Lens, Lock & Key, Lockpick* **50** *Lodestone, Lute, Magnifying Glass, Manacles, Marbles, Mask, Metal File, Mirror, Mugwort, Net* **60** *Oil Can (6u), Oilskin Bag, Pail, Paint, Parchment & Ink (3u), Perfume, Pickaxe, Pipe, Pliers, Poison* **70** *Pole (10ft), Poncho (petty), Pulley, Random Spellbook, Rope (25ft), Sack, Saw, Scissors, Scroll of Random Spellbook (petty), Sealable Bottle* **80** *Sedative, Sewing Kit, Sextant, Shovel, Signal Flag, Smokebomb, Smoking Herbs (3u), Songbook, Spiked Boots, Spyglass* **90** *Stylus, Tar, Tent (fits 2, bulky), Tongs, Trap (d6 STR damage), Wagon (+8 slots, slow), Waterproof Bag, Whetstone, Whistle (petty), Wig Wolfsbane*

Combat

◆ Procedure

A round of combat (~10s) includes:

1. (PCs lose first turn on failed DEX save)
2. All PCs take actions simultaneously
   1. Move up to 40ft (12m)
   2. Move again or do other action
3. All NPCs take actions simultaneously
4. Ends on defeat, flight or surrender

◆ Fighting

Attacks in combat always hit.

Attack rolling d6, d8 or d10
- d4 if **impaired**
- d12 if **enhanced**
- xdY highest for **multiple** weapons
- dY targets hit with **blast**

Damage of attack roll
- reduced by ARM
- excess reduces HP
- exactly to 0 gives **scar**
- excess reduces STR (critical)
- failed STR save makes **downed**
- NPCs are dead instead

Ranged attacks impaired on long distance
- too far if you can't see white in their eyes
- ammunition not usually tracked

Retreat requires a DEX save
- and a safe destination to run to

Morale checked for NPCs with WIL save
- when enemies take first casualty
- when they lose half their number
- some groups use leader's WIL
- lone foes must save at 0 HP

Detachments pool groups of similar foes
- or a large creature occasionally
- routed/split/struck on critical damage
- destroyed when STR reduced to 0
- 1 vs. detachment is impaired
- detachment vs. 1 is enhanced + blast

◆ Healing

Attributes can be reduced by events
- 0 STR is **dead**
- 0 DEX is **paralyzed**
- 0 WIL is **delirious**

Deprived when lacking crucial needs
- like food, water, rest, etc.
- adds 1 fatigue each day
- prevents recovering HP or attributes

Restore HP w/ brief rest + water

Stabilize downed character w/ bandages

Restore attributes w/ week's rest + healer

On death create a new character to join

◆ Magic

Casting spells can be done by anyone
- holding the spellbook in two hands
- reading its contents aloud
- adds 1 fatigue to inventory

In danger or deprived requires WIL save
- ill effects for failure on par with intent
- fatigue, damage, injury, death, etc.

Enhancing spells requires time and safety

Scrolls are petty variants
- disappearing after 1 use
- do not cause fatigue

Relics are imbued with power or spell
- of limited use with recharge condition
- do not cause fatigue

◆ Scars

Permanent effects of combat injuries.

[1] **Lasting scar** *HP = max(HP, 1d6), 1d6 for neck, hands, eye, chest, legs or ear*

[2] **Rattling blow** *HP = max(HP, 1d6) on refocus, disoriented and shaken*

[3] **Walloped** *HP = HP + 1d6 on recovery, deprived until rest for a few hours*

[4] **Broken limb** *HP = max(HP, 2d6) on recovery, 1d6 for legs, arms, rib or skull*

[5] **Diseased** *HP = max(HP, 2d6) on recovery, gross and uncomfortable infection*

[6] **Reorienting head wound** *attr = max(attr, 3d6), 1d6 for STR, DEX or WIL*

[7] **Hamstrung** *DEX = max(DEX, 3d6) on recovery, barely mobile until serious help*

[8] **Deafened** *WIL += 1d4 on WIL save, needs extraordinary aid to regain hearing*

[9] **Re-brained** *WIL = max(WIL, 3d6), hidden part of psyche knocked loose*

[10] **Sundered** *WIL += 1d6 on WIL save, appendage is torn off, crippled, or useless*

[11] **Mortal wound** *HP = 2d6 on recovery, deprived and out, dying in 1h unless healed*

[12] **Doomed** *HP = max(HP, 3d6) on crit save, dying horribly on failure*

Armor & Weapons (d6)

Armor *Additional Gear (0), Shield (+1), Helmet (+1), Gambeson (+1), Chainmail (2, bulky), Plate (3, bulky)* **Weapons** *Dagger (d6), Sword (d8), Halberd (d10, bulky), Sling (d6), Bow (d6, bulky), Crossbow (d8, bulky)*

Names (d100)

Adair, Alaric, Alder, Amaris, Anwen, Arlo, Ash, Aster, Ballad **10** *Barley, Basil, Beatrix, Birch, Bram, Briar, Brook, Bryn, Cai, Callan* **20** *Carver, Cedric, Cinder, Cliff, Corin, Crow, Dain, Darnel, Dax, Dorian* **30** *Eira, Elowen, Ember, Eon, Evander, Falcon, Faris, Fern, Finch, Flint* **40** *Freya, Gale, Garen, Hazel, Hemlock, Idris, Ivy, Juniper, Kael, Kavi* **50** *Keir, Leif, Liora, Lucan, Lyra, Lysander, Marius, Marlowe, Milo, Moss* **60** *Nazira, Neria, Noa, Nyx, Onyx, Orla, Pan, Patch, Perran, Quill* **70** *Rain, Reed, River, Robin, Rowan, Rune, Rush, Rye, Sable, Sage* **80** *Selene, Shade, Silas, Sky, Soren, Sparrow, Stellan, Stone, Storm, Talon* **90** *Thistle, Thorn, Thresh, Valen, Vesper, Vex, Willow, Winslow, Wisp, Wren Yarrow*

Traits (d10)

Age *(2d20+10)* **Physique** *Athletic, Brawny, Flabby, Lanky, Rugged, Scrawny, Short, Statuesque, Stout, Towering* **Skin** *Birthmarked, Marked, Oily, Rosy, Scarred, Soft, Tanned, Tattooed, Weathered, Webbed* **Hair** *Bald, Braided, Curly, Filthy, Frizzy, Long, Luxurious, Oily, Wavy, Wispy* **Face** *Bony, Broken, Chiseled, Elongated, Pale, Perfect, Rakish, Sharp, Square, Sunken* **Speech** *Blunt, Booming, Cryptic, Droning, Formal, Gravelly, Precise, Squeaky, Stuttering, Whispery* **Clothing** *Antique, Bloody, Elegant, Filthy, Foreign, Frayed, Frumpy, Livery, Rancid, Soiled* **Virtue** *Ambitious, Cautious, Courageous, Disciplined, Gregarious, Honorable, Humble, Merciful, Serene, Tolerant* **Vice** *Aggressive, Bitter, Craven, Deceitful, Greedy, Lazy, Nervous, Rude, Vain, Vengeful*